12-WEEK GLUTE & STRENGTH

A progressive 3-day gym program for women

3 phases • 36 workouts • printable weekly trackers

Consult a qualified professional before starting. Stop if you feel pain. For personal use only.

Welcome

This 12-week plan uses well-established strength exercises - hip thrusts, Romanian deadlifts, squats, split squats and more - organized into three 4-week phases. Each phase builds on the last by gradually adjusting sets, reps, rest and load. Train 3 days per week with at least one rest day between sessions.

Important - please read

Safety & disclaimer

This program is general fitness information, not medical advice. **Consult a qualified professional (such as your doctor or a certified trainer) before starting**, especially if you are pregnant, postpartum, have an injury or a medical condition. **Stop any exercise that causes pain**, dizziness or unusual discomfort. Individual results vary and no specific outcome is promised. Use proper technique and safe equipment, and use a spotter or safety pins where appropriate.

How to use this program

- **Schedule:** 3 sessions per week (e.g. Mon / Wed / Fri). Day A and Day C are lower-body focused; Day B adds upper body.
- **Sets x reps:** '3 x 10-12' means 3 sets of 10 to 12 repetitions.
- **Effort (RIR):** 'Reps in reserve' - how many more good reps you could have done. RIR 2 = stop with about 2 reps left.
- **Rest:** rest the listed time between sets. Longer rest for heavier work.
- **Log it:** print one weekly tracker per week and record weight and reps for every set.
- **Missed a session?** Just continue with the next one. Repeat a week if you need more time.
- **Substitutions:** if equipment is unavailable, use the listed alternative or a similar movement pattern.

Progression guidance

- Use **double progression**: when you reach the top of the rep range on all sets with good form, increase the load next session by the smallest available step (about 2-5% or 2.5-5 lb / 1-2.5 kg).
- If you cannot hit the bottom of the rep range, keep the same weight until you can.
- Form first - every rep should be controlled through a full, comfortable range of motion.
- Week 4, 8 and 12 are lighter 'deload / check-in' weeks: do about 2/3 of the usual sets (always at least one fewer; 2-set moves drop to 1) at the same weight to recover.
- Sleep, regular meals and hydration support training - adjust to what works for you.

Warm-up (8-10 minutes, every session)

Exercise	Dose	Cue
Brisk walk, bike or rower	3-5 min	Easy pace, gradually warmer
Glute bridge	2 x 12	Squeeze glutes at the top, ribs down
Banded lateral walk	2 x 10 each way	Small steps, knees track over toes
Bodyweight squat	1 x 10	Sit between hips, chest proud
Hip hinge with dowel	1 x 10	Push hips back, stick stays on back
World's greatest stretch	5 each side	Slow, controlled rotation
Ramp-up sets	2-3 sets	Lighter sets of your first lift before working weight

Cool-down (5 minutes)

Easy walking, then gentle stretches for hips, hamstrings and quads - about 30 seconds each, no bouncing and never into pain.

Exercise guide

Variations such as 'paused' or 'weighted' use the same cues as the base exercise.

Exercise	Key form cues	Alternative
Barbell hip thrust	Upper back on bench, chin tucked, drive through heels, full hip extension, pause at top	Glute bridge / machine
Romanian deadlift (RDL)	Soft knees, hips back, bar close to legs, neutral spine, stop at hamstring stretch	Dumbbell RDL
Back or goblet squat	Brace, knees follow toes, depth you can control, stand tall	Leg press
Bulgarian split squat	Back foot on bench, slight forward lean, front knee tracks toes	Reverse lunge
Cable kickback	Neutral spine, move from the hip, no lower-back arching	Band kickback
Hip abduction	Controlled tempo, pause at the end range	Banded side-lying raise
Step-up	Whole foot on box, drive through front leg, control down	Lower box
Lat pulldown	Chest up, elbows down toward ribs	Assisted pull-up
Dumbbell bench press	Shoulder blades set, wrists stacked, controlled lowering	Push-up
Seated cable row	Tall posture, pull elbows back, no swinging	Dumbbell row

Exercise	Key form cues	Alternative
Dumbbell shoulder press	Brace, press up and slightly back, no arching	Landmine press
Goblet squat (paused)	Hold a dumbbell at chest, sit down, pause 2 s at the bottom, stand tall	Box squat
Glute bridge (paused)	Feet hip-width, drive through heels, pause 2 s at top, ribs down	Banded glute bridge
B-stance hip thrust	Front foot flat, back heel lifted for balance; most work through the front leg	Single-leg glute bridge
Single-leg hip thrust	Same set-up as hip thrust, one foot planted, hips stay level	Two-leg hip thrust, lighter
Single-leg RDL	Hinge on one leg, hips square to floor, slight knee bend; hold support if needed	Kickstand RDL (back toe down)
Plank	Forearms under shoulders, ribs down, squeeze glutes, steady breathing	Knee plank
Side plank	Elbow under shoulder, body in a straight line, hips lifted	Side plank from knees
Dead bug	Low back stays near the floor; move opposite arm and leg slowly	Heel taps (arms still)

Phase 1 - Foundation

Weeks 1-4 - Learn the movements, build a base. Moderate weights, RIR 3. Week 4 = deload.

Day A - Glutes & Hamstrings

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest
Barbell hip thrust	3 x 10-12	90 s
Romanian deadlift	3 x 10-12	90 s
Goblet squat	3 x 12	60 s
Cable kickback	2 x 12 each	45 s
Hip abduction	2 x 15	45 s
Dead bug	2 x 8 each	45 s

Day B - Upper + Glutes

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest
Lat pulldown	3 x 10-12	75 s
Dumbbell bench press	3 x 10-12	75 s
Seated cable row	3 x 12	60 s
Glute bridge (paused)	3 x 12	60 s
Dumbbell shoulder press	2 x 12	60 s
Plank	3 x 30 s	45 s

Day C - Quads & Glutes

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest
Back squat	3 x 10	2 min
Bulgarian split squat	3 x 10 each	75 s
Step-up	2 x 10 each	60 s
Hip thrust (single-leg or light)	2 x 12	60 s
Hip abduction	2 x 15	45 s
Side plank	2 x 20 s each	45 s

Phase 2 - Build

Weeks 5-8 - More sets, slightly heavier. RIR 2. Week 8 = deload.

Day A - Glutes & Hamstrings

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest
Barbell hip thrust	4 x 8-10	2 min
Romanian deadlift	4 x 8-10	2 min
Goblet squat (pause)	3 x 10	75 s
Cable kickback	3 x 12 each	45 s
Hip abduction	3 x 15	45 s
Dead bug	3 x 8 each	45 s

Day B - Upper + Glutes

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest
Lat pulldown	4 x 8-10	90 s
Dumbbell bench press	4 x 8-10	90 s
Seated cable row	3 x 10	75 s
B-stance hip thrust	3 x 10 each	60 s
Dumbbell shoulder press	3 x 10	60 s
Plank	3 x 40 s	45 s

Day C - Quads & Glutes

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest
Back squat	4 x 8	2 min
Bulgarian split squat	3 x 8-10 each	90 s
Step-up	3 x 10 each	60 s
Single-leg RDL	3 x 10 each	60 s
Hip abduction	3 x 15	45 s
Side plank	3 x 25 s each	45 s

Phase 3 - Strength

Weeks 9-12 - Heavier, lower reps on main lifts, longer rest. RIR 1-2. Week 12 = deload & check-in. If your technique on squats, hip thrusts or RDLs isn't solid yet, stay at Phase 2 loading and reps - progress is still progress.

Day A - Glutes & Hamstrings

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest
Barbell hip thrust	5 x 6-8	2-3 min
Romanian deadlift	4 x 6-8	2-3 min
Goblet squat	3 x 10	75 s
Cable kickback	3 x 10-12 each	45 s
Hip abduction	3 x 12-15	45 s
Dead bug	3 x 10 each	45 s

Day B - Upper + Glutes

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest
Lat pulldown	4 x 6-8	2 min
Dumbbell bench press	4 x 6-8	2 min
Seated cable row	3 x 8-10	90 s
Hip thrust (paused 2 s)	3 x 8	90 s
Dumbbell shoulder press	3 x 8	75 s
Plank	3 x 45 s	45 s

Day C - Quads & Glutes

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest
Back squat	5 x 5	2-3 min
Bulgarian split squat	4 x 6-8 each	2 min
Step-up (weighted)	3 x 8 each	75 s
Single-leg RDL	3 x 8 each	75 s
Hip abduction	3 x 15	45 s
Side plank	3 x 30 s each	45 s

Week 1 Tracker

Phase 1 - Foundation • Dates: _____

Day A - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Barbell hip thrust (3 x 10-12)					
Romanian deadlift (3 x 10-12)					
Goblet squat (3 x 12)					
Cable kickback (2 x 12 each)					
Hip abduction (2 x 15)					
Dead bug (2 x 8 each)					

Day B - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Lat pulldown (3 x 10-12)					
Dumbbell bench press (3 x 10-12)					
Seated cable row (3 x 12)					
Glute bridge (paused) (3 x 12)					
Dumbbell shoulder press (2 x 12)					
Plank (3 x 30 s)					

Day C - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Back squat (3 x 10)					
Bulgarian split squat (3 x 10 each)					
Step-up (2 x 10 each)					
Hip thrust (single-leg or light) (2 x 12)					
Hip abduction (2 x 15)					
Side plank (2 x 20 s each)					

Write weight x reps in each box (e.g. 60x10). Leave unused set boxes blank.

Notes - how I felt, sleep, what to change next week

Week 2 Tracker

Phase 1 - Foundation • Dates: _____

Day A - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Barbell hip thrust (3 x 10-12)					
Romanian deadlift (3 x 10-12)					
Goblet squat (3 x 12)					
Cable kickback (2 x 12 each)					
Hip abduction (2 x 15)					
Dead bug (2 x 8 each)					

Day B - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Lat pulldown (3 x 10-12)					
Dumbbell bench press (3 x 10-12)					
Seated cable row (3 x 12)					
Glute bridge (paused) (3 x 12)					
Dumbbell shoulder press (2 x 12)					
Plank (3 x 30 s)					

Day C - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Back squat (3 x 10)					
Bulgarian split squat (3 x 10 each)					
Step-up (2 x 10 each)					
Hip thrust (single-leg or light) (2 x 12)					
Hip abduction (2 x 15)					
Side plank (2 x 20 s each)					

Write weight x reps in each box (e.g. 60x10). Leave unused set boxes blank.

Notes - how I felt, sleep, what to change next week

Week 3 Tracker

Phase 1 - Foundation • Dates: _____

Day A - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Barbell hip thrust (3 x 10-12)					
Romanian deadlift (3 x 10-12)					
Goblet squat (3 x 12)					
Cable kickback (2 x 12 each)					
Hip abduction (2 x 15)					
Dead bug (2 x 8 each)					

Day B - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Lat pulldown (3 x 10-12)					
Dumbbell bench press (3 x 10-12)					
Seated cable row (3 x 12)					
Glute bridge (paused) (3 x 12)					
Dumbbell shoulder press (2 x 12)					
Plank (3 x 30 s)					

Day C - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Back squat (3 x 10)					
Bulgarian split squat (3 x 10 each)					
Step-up (2 x 10 each)					
Hip thrust (single-leg or light) (2 x 12)					
Hip abduction (2 x 15)					
Side plank (2 x 20 s each)					

Write weight x reps in each box (e.g. 60x10). Leave unused set boxes blank.

Notes - how I felt, sleep, what to change next week

Week 4 Tracker

Phase 1 - Foundation - DELOAD week: reduced sets are shown, same weights • Dates: _____

Day A - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Barbell hip thrust (2 x 10-12)					
Romanian deadlift (2 x 10-12)					
Goblet squat (2 x 12)					
Cable kickback (1 x 12 each)					
Hip abduction (1 x 15)					
Dead bug (1 x 8 each)					

Day B - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Lat pulldown (2 x 10-12)					
Dumbbell bench press (2 x 10-12)					
Seated cable row (2 x 12)					
Glute bridge (paused) (2 x 12)					
Dumbbell shoulder press (1 x 12)					
Plank (2 x 30 s)					

Day C - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Back squat (2 x 10)					
Bulgarian split squat (2 x 10 each)					
Step-up (1 x 10 each)					
Hip thrust (single-leg or light) (1 x 12)					
Hip abduction (1 x 15)					
Side plank (1 x 20 s each)					

Write weight x reps in each box (e.g. 60x10). Leave unused set boxes blank.

Notes - how I felt, sleep, what to change next week

Week 5 Tracker

Phase 2 - Build • Dates: _____

Day A - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Barbell hip thrust (4 x 8-10)					
Romanian deadlift (4 x 8-10)					
Goblet squat (pause) (3 x 10)					
Cable kickback (3 x 12 each)					
Hip abduction (3 x 15)					
Dead bug (3 x 8 each)					

Day B - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Lat pulldown (4 x 8-10)					
Dumbbell bench press (4 x 8-10)					
Seated cable row (3 x 10)					
B-stance hip thrust (3 x 10 each)					
Dumbbell shoulder press (3 x 10)					
Plank (3 x 40 s)					

Day C - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Back squat (4 x 8)					
Bulgarian split squat (3 x 8-10 each)					
Step-up (3 x 10 each)					
Single-leg RDL (3 x 10 each)					
Hip abduction (3 x 15)					
Side plank (3 x 25 s each)					

Write weight x reps in each box (e.g. 60x10). Leave unused set boxes blank.

Notes - how I felt, sleep, what to change next week

Week 6 Tracker

Phase 2 - Build • Dates: _____

Day A - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Barbell hip thrust (4 x 8-10)					
Romanian deadlift (4 x 8-10)					
Goblet squat (pause) (3 x 10)					
Cable kickback (3 x 12 each)					
Hip abduction (3 x 15)					
Dead bug (3 x 8 each)					

Day B - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Lat pulldown (4 x 8-10)					
Dumbbell bench press (4 x 8-10)					
Seated cable row (3 x 10)					
B-stance hip thrust (3 x 10 each)					
Dumbbell shoulder press (3 x 10)					
Plank (3 x 40 s)					

Day C - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Back squat (4 x 8)					
Bulgarian split squat (3 x 8-10 each)					
Step-up (3 x 10 each)					
Single-leg RDL (3 x 10 each)					
Hip abduction (3 x 15)					
Side plank (3 x 25 s each)					

Write weight x reps in each box (e.g. 60x10). Leave unused set boxes blank.

Notes - how I felt, sleep, what to change next week

Week 7 Tracker

Phase 2 - Build • Dates: _____

Day A - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Barbell hip thrust (4 x 8-10)					
Romanian deadlift (4 x 8-10)					
Goblet squat (pause) (3 x 10)					
Cable kickback (3 x 12 each)					
Hip abduction (3 x 15)					
Dead bug (3 x 8 each)					

Day B - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Lat pulldown (4 x 8-10)					
Dumbbell bench press (4 x 8-10)					
Seated cable row (3 x 10)					
B-stance hip thrust (3 x 10 each)					
Dumbbell shoulder press (3 x 10)					
Plank (3 x 40 s)					

Day C - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Back squat (4 x 8)					
Bulgarian split squat (3 x 8-10 each)					
Step-up (3 x 10 each)					
Single-leg RDL (3 x 10 each)					
Hip abduction (3 x 15)					
Side plank (3 x 25 s each)					

Write weight x reps in each box (e.g. 60x10). Leave unused set boxes blank.

Notes - how I felt, sleep, what to change next week

Week 8 Tracker

Phase 2 - Build - DELOAD week: reduced sets are shown, same weights • Dates: _____

Day A - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Barbell hip thrust (3 x 8-10)					
Romanian deadlift (3 x 8-10)					
Goblet squat (pause) (2 x 10)					
Cable kickback (2 x 12 each)					
Hip abduction (2 x 15)					
Dead bug (2 x 8 each)					

Day B - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Lat pulldown (3 x 8-10)					
Dumbbell bench press (3 x 8-10)					
Seated cable row (2 x 10)					
B-stance hip thrust (2 x 10 each)					
Dumbbell shoulder press (2 x 10)					
Plank (2 x 40 s)					

Day C - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Back squat (3 x 8)					
Bulgarian split squat (2 x 8-10 each)					
Step-up (2 x 10 each)					
Single-leg RDL (2 x 10 each)					
Hip abduction (2 x 15)					
Side plank (2 x 25 s each)					

Write weight x reps in each box (e.g. 60x10). Leave unused set boxes blank.

Notes - how I felt, sleep, what to change next week

Week 9 Tracker

Phase 3 - Strength • Dates: _____

Day A - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Barbell hip thrust (5 x 6-8)					
Romanian deadlift (4 x 6-8)					
Goblet squat (3 x 10)					
Cable kickback (3 x 10-12 each)					
Hip abduction (3 x 12-15)					
Dead bug (3 x 10 each)					

Day B - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Lat pulldown (4 x 6-8)					
Dumbbell bench press (4 x 6-8)					
Seated cable row (3 x 8-10)					
Hip thrust (paused 2 s) (3 x 8)					
Dumbbell shoulder press (3 x 8)					
Plank (3 x 45 s)					

Day C - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Back squat (5 x 5)					
Bulgarian split squat (4 x 6-8 each)					
Step-up (weighted) (3 x 8 each)					
Single-leg RDL (3 x 8 each)					
Hip abduction (3 x 15)					
Side plank (3 x 30 s each)					

Write weight x reps in each box (e.g. 60x10). Leave unused set boxes blank.

Notes - how I felt, sleep, what to change next week

Week 10 Tracker

Phase 3 - Strength • Dates: _____

Day A - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Barbell hip thrust (5 x 6-8)					
Romanian deadlift (4 x 6-8)					
Goblet squat (3 x 10)					
Cable kickback (3 x 10-12 each)					
Hip abduction (3 x 12-15)					
Dead bug (3 x 10 each)					

Day B - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Lat pulldown (4 x 6-8)					
Dumbbell bench press (4 x 6-8)					
Seated cable row (3 x 8-10)					
Hip thrust (paused 2 s) (3 x 8)					
Dumbbell shoulder press (3 x 8)					
Plank (3 x 45 s)					

Day C - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Back squat (5 x 5)					
Bulgarian split squat (4 x 6-8 each)					
Step-up (weighted) (3 x 8 each)					
Single-leg RDL (3 x 8 each)					
Hip abduction (3 x 15)					
Side plank (3 x 30 s each)					

Write weight x reps in each box (e.g. 60x10). Leave unused set boxes blank.

Notes - how I felt, sleep, what to change next week

Week 11 Tracker

Phase 3 - Strength • Dates: _____

Day A - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Barbell hip thrust (5 x 6-8)					
Romanian deadlift (4 x 6-8)					
Goblet squat (3 x 10)					
Cable kickback (3 x 10-12 each)					
Hip abduction (3 x 12-15)					
Dead bug (3 x 10 each)					

Day B - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Lat pulldown (4 x 6-8)					
Dumbbell bench press (4 x 6-8)					
Seated cable row (3 x 8-10)					
Hip thrust (paused 2 s) (3 x 8)					
Dumbbell shoulder press (3 x 8)					
Plank (3 x 45 s)					

Day C - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Back squat (5 x 5)					
Bulgarian split squat (4 x 6-8 each)					
Step-up (weighted) (3 x 8 each)					
Single-leg RDL (3 x 8 each)					
Hip abduction (3 x 15)					
Side plank (3 x 30 s each)					

Write weight x reps in each box (e.g. 60x10). Leave unused set boxes blank.

Notes - how I felt, sleep, what to change next week

Week 12 Tracker

Phase 3 - Strength - DELOAD week: reduced sets are shown, same weights • Dates: _____

Day A - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Barbell hip thrust (3 x 6-8)					
Romanian deadlift (3 x 6-8)					
Goblet squat (2 x 10)					
Cable kickback (2 x 10-12 each)					
Hip abduction (2 x 12-15)					
Dead bug (2 x 10 each)					

Day B - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Lat pulldown (3 x 6-8)					
Dumbbell bench press (3 x 6-8)					
Seated cable row (2 x 8-10)					
Hip thrust (paused 2 s) (2 x 8)					
Dumbbell shoulder press (2 x 8)					
Plank (2 x 45 s)					

Day C - date: _____	Set 1	Set 2	Set 3	Set 4	Set 5
Back squat (3 x 5)					
Bulgarian split squat (3 x 6-8 each)					
Step-up (weighted) (2 x 8 each)					
Single-leg RDL (2 x 8 each)					
Hip abduction (2 x 15)					
Side plank (2 x 30 s each)					

Write weight x reps in each box (e.g. 60x10). Leave unused set boxes blank.

Notes - how I felt, sleep, what to change next week